

Response to referee comments:
PRD Submission DM13138,

T.Kimpson, S. Suvorova, H. Middleton, C. Liu, A. Melatos, R. Evans, W. Moran

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Author response to the second referee report for the paper DM13138, entitled '*Adaptive cancellation of mains power interference in continuous gravitational wave searches with a hidden Markov model*'.

We again thank the referee for their constructive review. We agree with all the comments and have made the recommended changes as described below.

Referee comments

1. *One response I am somewhat doubtful about is the one to my previous comment 14, on neglecting the Earth's movement. The authors have responded that F-statistic / matched-filter methods "correct" for this. This is true in the sense that the instantaneous signal frequency at any time is matched with the corresponding data bins in the right way. However, the actual amount of time a signal spends physically overlapping, or not, with a fixed-frequency instrumental line (or with a broader and complicated feature like the 60Hz mains) still depends on the Earth-induced frequency modulation. Hence, I would expect that performance depends on its inclusion, and can vary depending on the signal's sky location of origin, as different signals may become more or less separated from the noise feature. I agree with the authors that modelling that effect is not necessary for the scope of this paper, but a short comment seems warranted.*

Author response:

Yes, we agree with the referee that the Doppler frequency modulations can influence the time a monochromatic GW signal spends overlapping with the instrumental line. Specifically, for a GW source with intrinsic frequency f_0 , the frequency evaluated in the detector frame is

$$f(t) = f_0 \left(1 + \frac{\vec{v}(t)}{c} \cdot \vec{n} \right) \quad (1)$$

for sky position $\vec{n}$ and detector velocity $\vec{v}$. The detector velocity term includes both the diurnal and annual motions, which are typically of order $\mathcal{O}(10^{-6})$ and $\mathcal{O}(10^{-4})$ respectively (see e.g. arXiv:2111.12575). While the frequency modulations are small, generally narrower than the 60 Hz line (see e.g. Figure 2 in the manuscript), the referee is correct to point out that the Earth's motion will in principle influence the signal-vs-line behaviour. We have added a brief comment in Section IV A to discuss this point. We thank the referee for raising this subtlety to our attention.

2. *abstract: The wording "the LIGO detector" makes it sound like there is only one; it should be "one of the LIGO detectors" or "the LIGO Livingston detector".*

Author response:

Yes, we agree. The abstract has been updated to refer to "the LIGO Livingston detector"

3. *introduction: The Acernese+2014 Advanced Virgo detector reference (currently [19]) has been added to the list "[e.g. 16-19]", which otherwise contains CW results papers. This seems erroneous. Together with the current [6] and [9], for LIGO and KAGRA respectively, these citations should be attached to the names of the corresponding detectors, or in the first sentence where "interferometers" are first mentioned. The update "to advanced detectors" for the initial list of references about non-stationarities, though mentioned in the response, also does not seem to have actually happened in the resubmitted manuscript.*

Author response:

We now cite the LIGO, Virgo and Kagra papers in the first sentence of the introduction after "interferometers", as suggested by the referee. The list of references in the second sentence of the introduction, re non-stationarities, has now been updated to reference more modern papers, as per the referee's original suggestion. Specifically, we now cite

- Abbot et al. 2016 "Characterization of transient noise in Advanced LIGO relevant to gravitational wave signal GW150914"
- Davis et al. 2021 "LIGO detector characterization in the second and third observing runs"
- Davis et al. 2022 "Detector Characterization and Mitigation of Noise in Ground-Based Gravitational-Wave Interferometers"

- Glanzer et al. 2023 “Noise in the LIGO Livingston Gravitational Wave Observatory due to Trains”

4. *Sec. II.C: The added sentence starting “It is an empirical question which depends on the properties of the underlying signal, as to the threshold value of C_{rr} ($f = 60\text{Hz}$) required for noise cancellation to work sufficiently” is difficult to read due to unclear grammatical antecedent: what is an empirical question is only said in the middle of the sentence, after the “which depends” intermission. Turning around the word order might help.*

Author response:

Yes we agree that this sentence as written is obscure. We have updated the sentence in the manuscript to be clearer.

5. *Sec. VI.A: The reference for O3 data should be doi.org/10.3847/1538-4365/acdc9f rather than the catalog paper currently used.*

Author response:

The reference has been updated.

6. *Fig. 10: To me this looks like the ANC is actually over-subtracting the real 60Hz feature to some degree. This is probably worth a comment and could be a useful aspect to study and improve in future work.*

Author response:

Yes we agree with the referee that for the particular example presented in Fig 10, the ANC marginally over-subtracts the noise. This is likely due to the non-linear relationship between the strain and the PEM channels, cf. the coherence discussion in II.C, and the free parameters of the ANC filter which could be tuned better, cf. Section V.B. We have added a brief comment to the end of the first paragraph of Section VI.B.